

NAWIDA STANIKZAI

NUTRITION COUNSELLOR, MoPH CERTIFIED | *MIYCN & Community Nutrition Specialist*

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District, Province, Afghanistan

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

MoPH-certified Nutrition Counsellor with 4+ years of frontline experience in BPHS facilities and Mobile Health and Nutrition Teams (MHNT) across Afghanistan. Specialized in IMAM/MIYCN protocols, malnutrition screening using MUAC and anthropometric assessment, Growth Monitoring and Promotion (GMP) for children under two, and IYCF counselling for mothers and caregivers. Proven track record identifying and referring SAM/MAM cases, conducting food demonstration sessions, supervising CHWs, and maintaining HMIS/BPHS reporting compliance. Experienced with INGOs including IRC, Terre des Hommes, and CARE Afghanistan. Committed to reducing child and maternal malnutrition in underserved provinces through culturally sensitive, community-based nutrition interventions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Nutrition Counsellor | International Rescue Committee (IRC)

January 2022 – Present | Nangarhar Province, Behsood District

- Screen 100+ children under five and 40+ pregnant and lactating women (PLW) weekly using MUAC, weight, height, and oedema assessment per IMAM protocols
- Conduct monthly Growth Monitoring and Promotion (GMP) for 80+ children under two, interpreting growth charts and providing age-appropriate MIYCN counseling
- Identify and refer 15+ SAM and 25+ MAM cases monthly to OPD-SAM/OPD-MAM services and nutrition nurses for therapeutic feeding
- Provide individual and group IYCF/MIYCN counseling to 60+ mothers and caregivers monthly on breastfeeding, complementary feeding, infection prevention, and iron-folic acid supplementation
- Conduct monthly complementary feeding food demonstrations using locally available nutritious foods (eggs, lentils, yogurt, seasonal vegetables)
- Train and supervise 10 Community Health Workers on malnutrition screening, key MIYCN messaging, and defaulter follow-up in 8 catchment villages
- Maintain daily registers and compile timely weekly/monthly HMIS nutrition reports aligned with BPHS and MoPH-PND protocols
- Identify defaulted cases and coordinate with CHWs for home visits, reducing default rates by 30% through active follow-up

Nutrition Counsellor | Terre des Hommes (Tdh) Afghanistan

March 2020 – December 2021 | Kunar Province, Asadabad District

- Served as frontline nutrition counsellor in Mobile Health and Nutrition Team (MHNT) delivering services to remote and conflict-affected communities
- Screened children 6-59 months and PLW for acute malnutrition using MUAC tape, digital scales, and height boards; recorded all measurements in OPD-SAM/OPD-MAM registers
- Provided culturally sensitive IYCF counseling to 50+ mothers monthly, emphasizing exclusive breastfeeding for six months and appropriate complementary feeding
- Established and facilitated monthly mother-to-mother support groups, reaching 30+ caregivers with nutrition education and peer support
- Coordinated with health shura members and community elders to promote acceptance of nutrition services and reduce treatment defaulting

- Delivered psychosocial support sessions to malnourished women and mothers of SAM children through established self-help groups

cv-library

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Nutrition & Dietetics Herat University, Faculty of Public Health	2014 – 2018
Nursing & Midwifery Diploma (MoPH-Accredited) Institute of Health Sciences, Kabul MoPH Exit Exam Completed	2012 – 2014
12th Grade Certificate Malalai High School, Herat Kankor Score: 285	2008 – 2012

TRAINING & CERTIFICATIONS

• Integrated Management of Acute Malnutrition (IMAM)	MoPH / IRC, 2022
• MIYCN Counselling Certification	MoPH Public Nutrition Department, 2021
• Growth Monitoring and Promotion (GMP)	Terre des Hommes, 2020
• IYCF Counselling Certification	UNICEF / MoPH, 2020
• HMIS/BPHS Reporting Training	MoPH / WHO, 2019
• Community Health Worker Supervision	IRC Afghanistan, 2019
• Infection Prevention and Control (IPC)	WHO Afghanistan, 2019
• Basic Life Support (BLS)	Afghan Red Crescent, 2018
• Psychological First Aid (PFA)	IRC / WHO, 2021

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Screening & Assessment: MUAC measurement | Weight/height recording | Oedema assessment | SAM/MAM classification | Anthropometric calculation | Growth chart interpretation

Counseling & Education: MIYCN individual counseling | Group IYCF sessions | Breastfeeding support | Complementary feeding guidance | Food demonstration | Behavioral change communication | Maternal nutrition counseling | IEC material utilization

Program & Reporting: HMIS data entry | BPHS reporting formats | OPD-SAM/OPD-MAM register maintenance | MCH handbook use | Defaulter tracing documentation | Monthly IMAM reporting

Community & Coordination: CHW training and mentorship | Community mobilization | Health shura engagement | Coordination with nutrition nurses and medical doctors | Mobile clinic team collaboration

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

- Facilitate monthly CHW coordination meetings to review screening data, identify gaps, and plan community outreach activities
- Established 6 mother-to-mother support groups reaching 90+ caregivers with sustained nutrition education and peer counseling
- Coordinate quarterly health shura meetings to align facility services with community nutrition priorities
- Conduct village-level nutrition awareness campaigns in 12 villages, reaching 500+ beneficiaries annually
- Led defaulter follow-up coordination, reducing treatment default rates by 30% through CHW home visit networks

LANGUAGES

Language	Proficiency	Level
Dari	Native	100%
Pashto	Fluent	85%

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- ACBAR-Registered NGO Networks
- MoPH Public Nutrition Linkages
- CHW Supervisor Networks

REFERENCES

Available upon request